



Sexual harassment of women in work

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Abstract

In this article, we address an analytical study of sexual harassment in the workplace. We divided our work into three aspects, which were summarized in the titles for more understanding, and to organize the work, we find:

1- The methodological aspect (the problem of research and methodology)

2- The theoretical aspect (theories explaining sexual harassment)

3- Study results (analysis of theoretical and field research data)

Sexual harassment in the workplace is a social phenomenon that is old in work societies, but recently found in sociological studies. There are many statistics that show this in sociology research. What we point out in this study is understanding sexual harassment in the workplace with a quality active methodology, and we try to understand its different forms at workplace.

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1. Introduction

Sexual harassment has spread in the workplace and is linked to women compared to men, according to a study by "ClaudeKATZ." A study in Algeria shows that 66% of women working in the public sector are exposed to sexual harassment (Mustapha, Commission nationale convulsive de promotion des droits de l'homme, le phénomène des harcèlements sexuels, 2014). But this does not mean that work led to the emergence of sexual harassment, as it is a phenomenon that affects all forms and organizations, such as families.

It appeared in society and spread in professional circles. It was known in the Middle Ages as the phenomenon of "Le droit du cuissage" (Association européenne des violences faite aux femmes au travail, 1990, p. 34), which entered factories and workshops as a social right, then the concept developed into sexual harassment as a phenomenon that opens the way for a theoretical and practical problem to be presented by the sociological studies that dealt with it in its social and professional context. Through this content, we search for sexual harassment in public and private institutions and ask the following question:

- Is sexual harassment of working women related to male power and professional authority within the workplace?
- What are the manifestations of sexual harassment?

In our field study, we relied on the qualitative approach, where the semi-directed interview technique was used to reach the facts in depth about the phenomenon of sexual harassment at work. It adds a social touch to sociological research in society and gives the researcher the opportunity to delve deeper and accurately look at the problematic of his research.

Our study group consists of 30 individuals of both sexes (men and women), working in both the public and private sectors.

2- Theories explaining sexual harassment:

In this aspect, we address the major theories that explain sexual harassment in the workplace, as they give importance to the social system within the workplace that is based on the sexual hierarchy or the professional organizational system that is based on the professional hierarchy. In this context, the third theory that gives importance to the force within Places of work, whether one subject is higher in hierarchy than the other subject or lower in rank.

For each of us, what is the most effective theory to explain sexual harassment at work?

2-1 Extreme theory:

This theory concluded that sexual harassment of working women is one of the most important manifestations that we observe in institutions. This act comes from men who exploit women at work. The roots of this exploitation go back to the prevailing patriarchal "Patriarcats" (Steven, Difference troubles: Queering social theory and sexual politics, 1997, p. 304) social system, in which there is a systemic domination of males over females. The family is the first contributor to the establishment of this system in which the father controls the family members and exercises his authority over them. The authority has passed from the father to the brother and with the expansion of the family and the emergence of social relations between families due to the bloody and spatial rapprochement in social groups that interact with each other within the framework of marriage and exchange relations between individuals arose roles within groups.

Each individual belongs to his group and plays a role within it, so these roles were divided according to the status of individuals, from men who protect within the group and women who take charge of education and upbringing of individuals. With the expansion of individuals and their interaction in social relations, the authority passed from the father to the cousin, who in turn protects from the social and economic aspect. The man assumes the role of the leader within his primary group, which gave him the authority to carry out his tasks. This system led to the spread of male power within social systems, where power was associated primarily with men and came from patriarchal protection.

The need for expansion has generated positions of power within the family and within society, owned by the man and acting according to it within him. However, this system has resulted in women being subjected to submission in many areas of their choices. With regard to sexual harassment in its various forms, which is based on male authority and even with the development of conditions Social and economic in society, women have become dealing with men in the same positions of authority within the work, but the patriarchal system that gave power to males has not changed, so men sexually harass in the workplace because they are the strongest socially (Steven, Op.cit, p. 305) .

If we go back to the patriarchal system, where the older woman enjoys power and makes decisions within the family, can we say that the woman enjoys a part of the power and sometimes translates it into sexual harassment?

2-2 Liberal Theory:

This theory dealt with the phenomenon of sexual harassment as an act in which several factors intervene and translate into social, cultural and economic

situations in the work context. The theory indicated that sexual harassment carries sexual practices based on gender disparity, so individuals differ in the roles they play at work and this appears in their actions.

This disparity between individuals is involved in sexual harassment, both at the socio-cultural level, which makes them men and women who differ in the identities that arise for them as a result of education and their interaction within society and its culture, or at the economic level, which creates roles that are consistent within the framework of individual affiliation to a varying economic and social level of an individual for another (Ronald, Human values and social change, finding from the value surveys, 2003, p. 63). Thus, the responsible at work or the owner of an institution differs from a female worker in it. Individuals who engage in sexual harassment take advantage of this disparity that divides individuals into social classes in order to carry out sexual harassment.

The theory also indicates the predominance of the sexual role over the professional role in the phenomenon of sexual harassment, which leads to the emergence of disparities at work. The disparity is not purely social, but we find it in the professional environment in which the actors involved are the sexual harasser and the sexually harassed (Ronald, Op.cit, p. 63). Sexual harassment can spread in higher-order circles, and this act creates disparities in the overlapping of roles within the workplace designated for the performance of professional and productive functions, but sexual harassment leads to the entry of acts of a sexual nature into the workplace.

If sexual harassment is caused by a professional authority, how can we understand the sexual harassment committed by a working woman towards her supervisor at work?

2-3- Connell's theory:

In his study of gender and power in 1987 and types of masculinity in 1990, "Connell" presents the most important theories of gender (Anthony, 2012, p. 195), where he is interested in all its manifestations and concepts based on in-depth studies in this field.

He was interested in studying sexual relations within society and explaining sexual harassment according to the manifestations of the gender system. The researcher says that the phenomenon translates the power relations between its actors and in his presentation of social power as a factor interfering in the act, he referred to the male power that subject women to these acts, enjoyed by men within society and produces sexual harassment between individuals within the workplace.

3- Our study results:

3-1- The concept of sexual harassment at work:

Sexual harassment is the interaction of individuals in a social relationship within the work environment that bears a sexual aspect according to the standards of social outlook (Le sexe social) that divides between individuals and there is a disparity between the sexes, which leads to the emergence of two categories of males and females and the emergence of the system of exploitation. There is one group that exploits and another that is exposed to it among social groups, and these relations appear as a result of social upbringing between work groups, which leads to the emergence of both groups within the professional system. We conclude that every class system is authority relations, even in the workplace. Sexual harassment begins with the relationship of temptation, and the sexual harasser is in a relationship with the second party in the framework of work and interacts by exploiting situations,

so he is in the position of the party who controls the relationship and the authority and tries by all means to do his work and choose the appropriate situation.

We can't study the phenomenon of sexual harassment outside the context of culture and social structure. Authority relations constitute varying social structures. Sexual harassment translates into a position of authority and power within the workplace in which social relations are established between individuals who play professional roles.

3-2- Sexual harassment within institutions:

The phenomenon of sexual harassment comes in closed workplaces, as it is an act that carries requests and acts of a sexual nature that occur in offices and departments on a frequent basis and are not accepted by sexually harassed. This act comes from all professional levels and is not always and automatically issued by the highest-ranking officials, and the working woman is not the only one who is exposed to this act, but even men. Sexual harassment has nothing to do with seniority and can develop into sexual violence and lead to moral harassment, as it turned out in most of the cases that we saw in our field interviews, especially those related to women at work, and the perpetrator of sexual harassment could be outside the professional environment, and therefore he is not a worker in the institution. We also address the study of silence about sexual practices related to the woman she has been exposed to in order not to lose her job. Sexual harassment affects the internal relations of the institution, so we recorded resignations, absenteeism, and effects on the individual who was exposed to the act the lack of professional integration, failure to perform the job effectively, and defects in his professional and social relations. These effects were related to

working women more than they were to men, because the organization in its socio-economic aspect leads to a shortage of working conditions, which creates increasing pressures on workers who engage in sexual harassment, which shows the extent of an imbalance in the structure of individual relations within the workplace.

It refers to the professional organizations that do not care about the worker in individual structures that interact within an organizational system, and focus on the material aspect of professional relations. Sociological studies that dealt with the phenomenon of work such as Taylorism in America and qualitative episodes that are concerned with the phenomenon of production only, it is considered the material aspect of work, these came Studies with organizational thought do not care about the relationships that arise within the framework of the professional environment, as they increase the pressure on the human factor.

What led to the emergence of unorganized acts within the workplace, such as sexual harassment, which carries in its nature a kind of exploitation of professional and social roles and the mixing of them, which creates a role of a sexual nature, sometimes resulting from the occupational pressures that arose under the prevailing organization within the professional organizations of institutions. The phenomenon of sexual harassment in the workplace is an act that carries demands and practices that the party who is exposed to it does not desire. Therefore, it occurs within the framework of an individual relationship between the sexual harasser and the sexually harassed one. It does not translate into professional pressure in all of its cases. It leads to pressure on him to the point that he quits, but this does not mean that individuals in a situation of sexual harassment do not perform the functions attributed to them.

Sexual harassment is an abuse of power at work in the case of a sexual harasser who has a professional hierarchy over the sexual harasser. The first exercises a kind of authority in a professional framework and exploits it in order to carry out this act. We can say that the organization pattern imposes the emergence of social relations based on the functional hierarchy at work, which produces a authority that some individuals exploit to sexually harass others in individual relations. Professional organizations consist of social individuals with formal and informal relations, interactions between which arise in socio-professional patterns. Sexual harassment translates into another form of social relations within work, linked to work groups that sometimes exploit the functional hierarchy for their own action. Sexual harassment occurs in enclosed spaces such as offices, and the act can come from outside the organization into the organization.

3-3 Manifestations of sexual harassment in the workplace:

3-3-1 Sexual harassment is an extension of male sexual power to the workplace:

Our study indicated that sexual harassment of working women is nothing but an extension of male authority to the workplace. The roots of the act go back to the structure of the social system, which is based on male systemic dominance. This division led to a hierarchy and disparity in the relations between men and women, where the dominant masculinity and the dominated femininity appeared. This division is not purely biological, but rather increases this social division, and sexual harassment as bargaining on the basis of sexuality, carries demands and actions of a sexual nature practiced by men in order to exploit the authority that he possesses in

society and extends to the workplace. Researchers Anne ZELENSKY and Mireille GAUSSOT say that the phenomenon spread in the Middle Ages and the beginning of capitalism, and was known throughout history as the phenomenon of “the right of cuissage” (Mireille, pp. 35-36) as a right enjoyed by the strongest socially and sexually exercised on maids and waitresses in the 18th and 19th centuries. Even in the stage of the bourgeois system, confusion prevailed at that stage between what is economic and what we classify as sexual in nature related to the individual, whose identity dissolved in the collective perception that defined the laws that individuals follow within the framework of the hierarchy of classes in society on the basis of authority. The social system in our society is similar to the system prevailing in that period. It does not recognize individuals as individual identities. If it happened that a woman refused this act, the social law would punish her for not complying with the decisions of her master stipulated by the social system. As the two researchers say, the concept of the right of cuissage has changed with the development of social and economic reality in our modern era and this right is no longer recognized by society, and it became known as sexual harassment, which carries sexual acts that enter the workplace by individuals who carry out sexual harassment and the highest hierarchy in it. The two researchers add that the act affects the mental health of the woman, her social relations, the professional path of the institution and its identity. The study indicated that 1/10 of the female workers are exposed to this act, and the two researchers relied in their study on sexual harassment by referring to the study of “NICOLEAU Patrick,” on the subject in 1984 at the University of “Bordeaux” (GAUSSAUT, 1984, p. 43). He says that sexual harassment is linked to the masters

in society, and appeared in the bourgeois classes that remain silent in turn to act because it harms her social reputation. The researcher pointed out that sexual harassment is mostly related to domestic servants in that period (the beginning of capitalism), and he says that this category is exposed to sexual harassment in its various forms and is silent about the act because they need to work in the homes of the bourgeoisie, as a closed place where the employer imposes his orders on the maid and can be He harassed her, and she remained silent for fear of him.

Sexual harassment results from the nature of the “La servitude” relationship between the maid and her bourgeois master of social status. From the researcher’s point of view, sexual harassment is a silent phenomenon since its spread in the Middle Ages to the modern era. He also pointed out that sexual harassment is a new concept known as *forçage*. These concepts are known as an act that translates excessive authority on the part of the owners of factories and institutions by forcing the women who work for them to have sexual relations with them (GAUSSAUT, 1984, pp. 161-169). The two researchers conducted interviews with sexual harassers on the basis that they are looking for work and conducting interviews for employment in institutions and workplaces. In an interview with an official in an organization who harasses women, he says: “Of course I happened to jump little babes on the carpet in my office? This is the attitude of every Latin towards a woman, it is the need to seduce at work as in the subway, we are in the age of pleasure and overconsumption and in advertising, the spark is permanent” (Mireille, p. 136).

In its analyzes, our study addressed that male authority is a factor interfering with sexual harassment and gave a social view, as it indicated that the phenomenon of sexual harassment spread due to the excessive male sexual authority exercised

by men over women in the workplace, and the working woman is obliged to monitor inside institutions that strips her of her feminine identity, whether Through her working conditions or the relationships she has with officials, the hierarchical system prevailing at work reproduces authority and leads to the subordination of women to men.

In work, we find a social division based on gender for jobs. As for professional relations, they are based on hierarchy that generates authority. Most of the high positions are exploited by men for acts of a sexual nature, and women are exposed to bargains in their work in order to obtain a reward or promotion to higher positions bargains are of a sexual nature. Therefore, officials do not look at working women on the basis of their professional competencies, but on the basis of a sexual identity that can be exploited (Association européenne des violences faite aux femmes au travail, 1990, p. 54). When women reject these requests and practices, they are marginalized and threatened by sexual harassers, especially by employers and owners of institutions who consider working women as their property, which has led to the excessive male sexual authority that emerged as a result of patriarchal authority and spread in the workplace and translated by sexual harassment.

We also found in our study that sexual harassment affects the psychological aspect of women and the professional aspect, and the phenomenon is mainly related to other than the workplace, so we notice it within social systems such as families and it can take several forms of a sexual nature (Association européenne des violences faite aux femmes au travail, 1990, p. 115).

3-3-2 Sexual harassment and dual authority:

In his study on sexual harassment, "Claude Katz" (Claude, 2007, pp. 7-12) dealt with the factors that interfere in this social phenomenon that has been neglected and women are exposed to a large percentage compared to men who are exposed to the act at work by 3 %. According to our interviews, it was found that the act of sexual harassment affects the individual identity by violating the dignity of the working individual and expresses the male authority by considering the woman's body as property at the sexual harasser's disposal. Sexual harassment includes the sexual aspect of the working woman and is viewed as a sexual issue within the work. It does not translate a normal sexual desire, so the mutual admiration between a man and a woman at work can't be explained by sexual harassment. Our study also added another type of authority that intervenes in the act of sexual harassment and arises within the framework of professional relationships that are distributed in a hierarchical form according to positions and responsibilities that lead to the emergence of professional authority translated into male authority in another way. This act obstructs the principle of professional equality between men and women, and establishes inequality based on the principle of gender in the workplace. Men who engage in sexual harassment occupy higher positions compared to women who are subjected to this act. This act leads to the instability of work relations and is mainly related to the man (Claude, 2007, p. 43).

The roots of sexual harassment go back to the prevailing social systems and their reproduction despite the changes taking place, whether economic, social, as well as professional. On the other hand, our study dealt with the phenomenon of sexual harassment, in which the working woman is the perpetrator (the sexual harasser) as an act that translates her will to gain power

and authority in the workplace, and this causes a functional imbalance in the roles within the work community, And if the latter does not have professional authority at work, then the duality of professional roles is a factor that leads to sexual harassment at work. The sexual harasser exaggerates his role and his professional position in order to do his work.

Here we explain sexual harassment by the nature of hierarchical relationships. The action that the woman performs indicates her desire to gain power and control all situations, especially the man against whom she performs the act. And limiting the concept of sexual harassment to the power relations between the actors within the work environment, and the sexual harassment that men are exposed to leads to dysfunction in the social structure of the professional environment, as it is part of a large social system in which the phenomenon is spread.

3-3-3- Sexual harassment translates into a temptation relationship:

Researcher "Lydia M Fenner" addressed in an international forum in France entitled "Violence against working women in professional and public places" on March 14, 2014, under the supervision of the OPALE Institute (July, 2014, p. 376) , where she presented a concept of sexual violence against working women, which she is exposed to on a daily basis. These acts are spread in the workplace to the extent that it is difficult to notice them in all their forms, and sometimes reach physical violence, and this form of sexual acts leads to women feeling fear and marginalization, which makes men control the environment and do not feel fear but control. Sexual harassment creates a seduction relationship (seduction) (Seiler, 2003, p. 54) between the two parties and is in the form of actions that the women who are most likely to reject, and violence that amounts to threats and physical practices.

The woman remains silent about the act despite her feeling of fear and anxiety about this situation. The researcher also referred to some studies that believe that sexual comments make women feel that they are active in the professional environment, and feel integrated, which earns them an identity and status within the work because they are concerned with physical appearances, for example, commenting on the physical body. And the use of some methods of temptation makes him interact in the professional environment and feel satisfied with himself, Unless it reaches the stage of assault and harassment, because the social system divides between men and women and makes them (women) in a lower hierarchical rank than men (July, 2014, p. 401).

Sexual harassment is primarily related to the male element, and women are more likely to act than those who work in the night shift, as an indicator that translates into being prepared for this act. During the night, not all workers are present in the workplace, we take, for example, hospitals: The employees perform night shifts, which makes the sexual harassers take advantage of the situation in order to do their work, as Amal Awawda indicated in her research on the phenomenon of violence and sexual harassment in the workplace. The study sample included doctors and nurses, And she came to the conclusion that most of the women who work in the night shift are exposed to sexual harassment by doctors and nurses, and I also recorded that there are women who are exposed to abuse by patients inside hospitals (عواودة, 2004, p. 23).

Temptation can gain the working woman a position within the work and lead to achieving integration in her work, which makes her constrained by the physical aspects that can't be dispensed with, and doesn't take into account her professional

competencies as an active individual in the workplace. Temptation translates into a stage of sexual harassment that begins with making comments and using tempting methods on the part of the sexual harasser. In return, the woman accepts these comments unless they reach the stage of harassment. Noha says: These behaviours are acceptable unless they amount to harassment.

4- Our perspectives:

4-1- Actors of sexual harassment:

According to our study, which dealt with the study of the phenomenon in the professional environment, the study sample included the category of men and women involved in sexual harassment, and we referred to the category of men who actually abuse social authority on the basis of gender in order to exercise their actions on women in the work environment, Elizabeth KISSLING¹ named this model: male gaze, which translates the category of men who sexually harass believing that they own a woman's body on their side and at their disposal to show their authority over her from her sexual and physical side. In another study, DEBOUT Michel²: men who engage in this act ranged between the ages of 30 and 50 years, most of them are married and harass women in order to take advantage of their professional position in order to subdue them, they occupy positions of higher hierarchy and use them for a purpose of a sexual nature depending on strategies to reach their purpose from the use of temptation to the application of the act. We find them opportunists,

seduction tactics and exploiting professional authority³.

Our study shows that the category of actors is not limited to the category of married men or who abuse professional authority only, but even the category of women who sexually harass in the workplace.

4-2- Categories exposed to sexual harassment and its consequences:

This act affects the psychological level of the sexually harassed. Robert Matieur's study recorded 65% of women feeling anxious and stressed, 35% of whom make professional mistakes among the women who represent the study sample. The researcher indicated that 03% of the cases of divorce, 02% of the cases of attempted suicide, and 01% of the cases agreed to sexual harassment. The researcher adds that cases of suicide, divorce and consent to the act are the result of social factors, so women are exposed to social rulings that make them agree or remain silent about the act, and a feeling of guilt arises within them because society holds them responsible, as they are the ones who have exceeded the patriarchal authority that protects them. The professional environment is silent about the phenomenon for fear of losing work, especially if the actor is higher in hierarchy⁴. The interview we conducted with "Sarah", who told her female accountant colleague that she is being sexually harassed by the employer, shows her: "You exaggerate, you take your desires for reality". The professional environment bears responsibility for the action on the working woman for fear of losing the job.

¹-Deider, McCann., *Sexual harassment at work ,condition of work and employment series*, N° 02,2005, p03

² - Michel, DEBOUT., *Le harcèlement moral au travail*, France, Ed des journaux officiels, 2018, p126.

³-Op.cit. Michel, DEBOUT., 126

⁴- Robert, MATIEUR., *Cahier du genre*, France, Ed Cairn, 2010, p 49.

Married women are exposed to the phenomenon of sexual harassment, so the researcher referred to divorce cases, but didn't take this category into account. Sexual harassment can lead to divorce cases if the husband knows that his wife has been exposed to such acts that affect the trust of the spouses, especially if the perpetrator of the sexual harassment is a friend of the working woman, or rather pretends to be friendship. Or rather, pretend friendship, "Samira", an employee in a public institution who was sexually harassed by a friend with whom she has a professional and social relationship says: "I can't tell my husband that I was sexually harassed...because I know the perpetrator, he was a friend of mine at work...If my husband knew, he could That we get divorced, what do I say to my children when they grow up, I represent the honIntroduction

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List of references or and dignity of the family in front of others...". Hayat, a cleaner in a public institution, adds: "I didn't tell my husband for fear of losing my job and I badly need it". The study dealt with the groups that were exposed to the act represented by working women and didn't refer to the category of harassers, whether men or women. There are also women who accept this act for the sake of professional interests represented in promotion, increase in wages, and absenteeism from work,

which explains that sexual harassment translates into an exchange of interests Here, we do not remain in sexual harassment, but rather express another form of acts of a sexual nature. If we remain in sexual harassment, the woman is exposed to bargains of a sexual nature and pressures to accept the act.

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